

B1

GRAMMAR LESSON · PAST TENSES

Past Perfect

The past before the past: had + past participle.

Geçmişten Önceki Geçmiş

QUICK UNDERSTANDING

Past Perfect, geçmişte bahsettiğimiz bir andan **daha önce olmuş** bir olayı anlatır — yani "geçmişin geçmişi"dir. Türkçedeki "-mişti" ekiyle (gitmişti, bitirmişti, görmüştü) örtüşür: bir olay, başka bir geçmiş olaydan önce zaten olup bitmiştir.

The Structure

Formula

Subject + had + V3 (past participle)

had, tüm öznelerle (I/you/he/she/it/we/they) AYNI kalır — has/have ayrımı yoktur; sadece V3 (fiilin üçüncü hali) kullanılır.

Affirmative / Negative / Question

AFFIRMATIVE

Subject + had + V3

They had finished dinner by 8pm.

NEGATIVE

Subject + hadn't + V3

He hadn't seen the message yet.

QUESTION

Had + subject + V3?

Had you met her before the party?

Word Order

Özne — had (+not) — V3 — (nesne). before/after/by the time cümleleri başta veya sonda olabilir.

- **By the time** the movie started, we **had** already **found** our seats. — Film başladığında biz çoktan yerlerimizi bulmuştuk.
- She **had** never **traveled** abroad **before** that trip. — O geziden önce hiç yurt dışına çıkmamıştı.

How It Works

When do we use it?

- **İki geçmiş olaydan daha önce gerçekleşeni belirtmek için:** The train had left before we got to the station.
- **Bir olaylar zincirinde en başta olanı vurgulamak için:** She had studied medicine before she became a writer.
- **before / after / by the time ile sıralama kurmak için:** By the time I called him, he had already heard the news.
- **already / just / never gibi zarflarla tamamlanmışlığı vurgulamak için:** I had never seen snow before that winter.

When DON'T we use it?

Sadece tek bir geçmiş olay anlatılıyorsa Past Perfect KULLANMA — iki olay arasında bir "önce/sonra" ilişkisi yoksa Past Simple yeterlidir.

✗ I had visited my grandmother last Sunday. → ✓ I visited my grandmother last Sunday.

had'i present perfect'teki have ile KARIŞTIRMA: ✗ I have had finished before you arrived. → ✓ I had finished before you arrived.

Short Answers

Yes, I had. / No, I hadn't.

Not: had, kısa cevaplarda tekrar edilmez ama V3 tekrarlanmaz, sadece had kalır.

Türkçe Mantığı

Zihninde şu sırayla ilerle:

TÜRKÇEDE NE DEMEK İSTİYORUM? → "Ben eve vardığımda o çoktan gitmişti." → İKİ GEÇMİŞ OLAY VAR MI, HANGİSİ DAHA ÖNCE? → gitmek (önce) — varmak (sonra) → ÖNCEKİ OLAY → Past Perfect (had + V3) / SONRAKİ OLAY → Past Simple → CÜMLE → "When I arrived home, she had already left."

Examples

TEMEL (HAD + V3)

- When I got to the airport, the plane had already taken off. — Havaalanına vardığımda uçak çoktan kalkmıştı.
- She had lived in three different countries before she turned twenty. — Yirmi yaşına gelmeden önce üç farklı ülkede yaşamıştı.
- They hadn't finished the project when the deadline arrived. — Teslim tarihi geldiğinde projeyi bitirmemişlerdi.

SIRALAMA (BEFORE/AFTER/BY THE TIME)

- By the time the guests arrived, Mert had cleaned the whole house. — Misafirler geldiğinde Mert bütün evi temizlemişti.
- After she had signed the contract, she felt relieved. — Sözleşmeyi imzaladıktan sonra rahatladı.
- The children were tired because they had walked for hours. — Çocuklar yorgundu çünkü saatlerdir yürümüşlerdi.

ALREADY/JUST/NEVER İLE

- I had just finished my coffee when the phone rang. — Telefon çaldığında kahvemi yeni bitirmiştim.
- Had you ever eaten sushi before that restaurant? — O restorandan önce hiç suşi yemiş miydin?
- We had never seen such a big storm before. — Daha önce hiç bu kadar büyük bir fırtına görmemiştik.
- I hadn't heard the news until my sister told me. — Kız kardeşim söyleyene kadar haberi duymamıştım.
- Zeynep had already left the office when I called her.

Compare & Notice

Compare With

Past Perfect

İki geçmiş olaydan daha ÖNCE olan.
She had left when I arrived.

Past Simple

İki geçmiş olaydan SONRA olan, ya da tek başına anlatılan olay.
I arrived at 6pm.

→ Past Perfect vs Past Simple konusuna git

Visual Timeline

Timeline: had + V3 (önce oldu) · Past Simple (sonra oldu, referans nokta)

Common Mistakes

✗ I had visited my grandmother last Sunday.

✓ I visited my grandmother last Sunday.

WHY? Tek bir geçmiş olay varsa, önce/sonra ilişkisi kurulmuyorsa Past Simple yeterlidir — Past Perfect ikinci bir geçmiş referans noktası gerektirir.

✗ When I arrived, she has already left.

✓ When I arrived, she had already left.

WHY? Present Perfect (has) şimdiyle bağlantılıdır; ama burada referans noktası geçmişte (arrived) olduğu için had (Past Perfect) gerekir.

✗ By the time we arrived, the film had start.

✓ By the time we arrived, the film had started.

WHY? had'den sonra fiil her zaman V3 (past participle) olmalı, V1 (yalın hal) değil.

✗ She had went to bed before I got home.

✓ She had gone to bed before I got home.

WHY? "go" fiilinin V3 hali "gone"dur, "went" (V2) değil — had + V2 karışımı sık yapılan bir hatadır.

Practice

Name: _____

Date: _____

Score: _____ / 19

PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. The train _____ before we got to the station.

a) has left

b) left had

c) was leaving before

d) had left

2. Find the mistake and correct it.

When I arrived, she ^A has already left ^B . ^C

Correction: _____

3. By the time we arrived, the film _____ .

a) starts

b) had start

c) had started

d) has started

PART B · PRACTICE

4. She _____ (study) medicine before she became a writer.

5. Find the mistake and correct it.

She had ^A went ^B to bed before I got home. ^C

Correction: _____

6. I _____ never _____ snow before I moved to Canada.

a) had / seen

b) had / saw

c) did / see

d) have / seen

7. Find the mistake and correct it.

I ^A had visited ^B my grandmother last Sunday. ^C

Correction: _____

8. You tell a friend why you couldn't enter your house.

Which sentence is correct?

a) I couldn't get in because I had lose my keys.

b) I couldn't get in because I had lost my keys.

c) I couldn't get in because I have lost my keys.

d) I couldn't get in because I lost my keys tomorrow.

9. "When we got there, the party had finished." What happened?

a) The party started when we arrived.

b) The party is still going on.

c) The party finished before we arrived.

d) We arrived before the party.

10. He was hungry because he _____ all day.

a) hadn't eaten

b) not eaten

c) hasn't eaten

d) didn't ate

PART C · FINAL CHECK

11. After she _____ her work, she went home.

- a) had finished b) had finish c) has finished d) finishing

12. I didn't know who he was. I _____ him before.

- a) don't meet b) haven't met c) hadn't met d) didn't met

13. By 2010, they _____ (live) in five different countries.

14. Find the mistake and correct it.

By the time we arrived, the film ^A had start ^{B C} .

Correction: _____

15. _____ you ever been abroad before you started university?

- a) Had b) Have c) Did d) Were

16. Your friend asks why you weren't hungry at the party.

What do you say?

- a) I had already ate at home.
b) I have already eaten at home.
c) I had already eaten at home.
d) I already eat at home.

17. "She had just left when you called." What happened first?

- a) They happened at the same time.
b) Nothing happened.
c) She left.
d) You called.

18. The streets were wet because it _____ .

- a) rains b) had rain c) had rained d) has rained

19. Join with "before": "He finished his homework. Then he watched TV."

He had finished his homework _____ .

Answer Key

Kısa açıklamalar, her cevabın hangi kurala dayandığını gösterir.

PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. **d) had left** — Daha önceki geçmiş → had + V3.
2. **B — has already left → had already left** — Geçmişteki bir andan önce → had left.
3. **c) had started** — had + V3: had started.

PART B · PRACTICE

4. **had studied** — Daha önceki olay → had studied.
5. **B — went → gone** — had + V3: gone.
6. **a) had / seen** — Geçmişteki bir ana kadar deneyim → had never seen.
7. **B — had visited → visited** — Tek bir geçmiş olay, sıralama yok → past simple.
8. **b) I couldn't get in because I had lost my keys.** — Önce anahtar kayboldu → had lost.
9. **c) The party finished before we arrived.** — had finished → varıştan önce bitmişti.
10. **a) hadn't eaten** — Açlıktan önceki durum → hadn't eaten.

PART C · FINAL CHECK

11. **a) had finished** — after ile önceki eylem → had finished.
12. **c) hadn't met** — Geçmişteki bir ana kadar → hadn't met.
13. **had lived** — by + geçmiş zaman → had lived.
14. **B — had start → had started** — had + V3.
15. **a) Had** — Geçmişteki bir andan önce deneyim → Had you ever been...?
16. **c) I had already eaten at home.** — Partiden önce → had eaten.
17. **c) She left.** — had left önce oldu, sonra aradın.
18. **c) had rained** — Önceki olay → had rained.
19. **He had finished his homework before he watched TV .** — Önceki eylem past perfect + before + past simple.

Bu dersin interaktif versiyonu (anında geri bildirimli alıştırma):

<https://abonlinenglish.school/grammar/b1/past-perfect>